

RIAs and enterprise apps

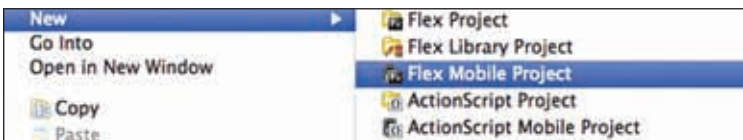
As discussed in the first chapter can also leverage existing services easily and then be turned into mobile applications. MAX Companion is an excellent RIA example. Similarly, so are the Acrobat Connect and the Standard Chartered Bank enterprise apps. We will now look at Flash Platform development for Android, BlackBerry, and iOS devices. Adobe's latest update to Flash Builder 4.5 has significantly boosted developer options and now supports publishing to Blackberry Tablet OS, iOS, and Android, thereby catering to the whole gamut of smartphone and tablet platforms currently available.

Android

Back in October 2010, Adobe first launched Adobe AIR 2.5 on the Android Market for all v2.2 “FroYo” devices. Adobe also launched a preview release of all the next generation tools that are in the market today which can be used for developing applications for mobile device using the Flash Platform: The newer versions Flash Builder 4.5, Flash Catalyst 5.5, and the Flex 4.5 framework is what we will be looking at for mobile application development.

Once you have Flash Builder 4.5 installed on your computer, you can create Android apps by using either Flex or ActionScript. You can make use of the Flash Builder to develop your application, test it on your computer using any of the emulators already provided by Adobe, deploy it on your Android device using a USB cable, and debug it if necessary while it's running on the device. After this entire process you can even submit the application to the Android Market. You can make use of the Flash Builder Export Release feature to build the APK file. On the other hand you can use Flash Professional CS5 for this as well.

Note that just like on a desktop, on an Android, the AIR applications use the AIR runtime which needs to be installed on the device. Imagine a scenario where an android user tries installing an app on his device without the runtime already installed on it. Just like on a desktop, it will not work without the runtime, but Flash prebuilds a feature into the package which



Starting a new Flex mobile project in the Flex 4.5 SDK